

Relanto

Prevention Of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Policy

Version 1.2, October 2025

Table of Contents

1. Document History	2
2. Foreword.....	3
2.1 Policy Statement	3
2.2 Scope & Eligibility	3
3. Guidelines	3
3.1 Definitions	3
3.2 Redressal Mechanism	5
3.3 Internal Committee	6
3.4 Procedures and Guidelines:	6
3.5 Disciplinary Action:.....	9
3.6 Confidentiality:	11
4. References	12
5. Exclusion.....	12
6. Non-Compliance	12
7. Revision of the Policy	12
8. Explanation/Deviation of Policy	12
9. Annexure	12

1. Document History

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2. Foreword

2.1 Policy Statement

This policy has been framed by the provisions of “The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013” and rules framed thereunder (hereinafter “the Act”). Accordingly, while the policy covers all the key aspects of the Act, for any further clarification reference shall always be made to the Act and the provisions of the Act shall prevail.

The purpose of this policy is to prevent any acts of sexual harassment and to provide an understanding of the mechanisms for redressal provided by Relanto – in the event of sexual harassment at the workplace.

Relanto is an equal-opportunity employer and recognizes that sexual harassment as a form of misconduct undermines the safety and dignity of all persons. We do not tolerate any verbal or physical misconduct that creates an intimidating, offensive, or hostile environment for our employees. Harassment of any kind, including sexual harassment, is forbidden in Relanto and every employee has the right to be protected against it.

We are committed to creating a healthy and safe working environment that enables employees to work without fear of prejudice, bias, and sexual harassment. All employees of Relanto have the right to be treated with dignity.

2.2 Scope & Eligibility

This policy applies to all the regular, full-time, trainees and contract employees of Relanto (whether in the office premises or outside while on assignment). This policy shall be a part of the employment contract or terms of engagement of the Employees of Relanto.

3. Guidelines

3.1 Definitions

a. Employee: is defined as a person employed at the workplace, for any work on a regular, temporary, ad-hoc, or daily wage basis, either directly or through an agent, including a contractor, with or without the knowledge of the principal employer, whether for remuneration or not, or working voluntarily or otherwise, whether the terms of employment are express or implied and includes a co-worker, a contract worker, probationer, trainee, apprentice or by any other such name.

b. Aggrieved Person: About a workplace, an employee, of any age, whether employed or not, who alleges to have been subjected to any act of sexual harassment by the respondent and includes contractual, temporary, visitors. Where the alleged incident occurs to our employee by a third party while on duty outside our premises, Relanto shall perform all reasonable and necessary steps to support our employee.

c. Respondent: A person against whom a complaint of sexual harassment has been made by the aggrieved employee.

d. Workplace: This policy applies to scenarios where employees travel outside their customary work location on business assignments appearing in an official capacity. In addition to the customary place of work (main office),

it shall also include any place where the employee visits in connection with his/her work, during and/or arising out of employment/ contract/ engagement with Relanto, including transportation provided for undertaking such a journey.

For example:

1. All offices or other premises where the Organization's business is conducted.
2. All Organization related activities performed at any physical or virtual site
3. Any social, business, or other functions taking place physically or virtually where the conduct or comments may have an adverse impact on the workplace or workplace relations.
4. Any alleged act of sexual harassment committed during or outside of office hours using any mode of communication including video calls/audio calls, phone calls, text, e-mails, on any social media platform or through any other electronic communication etc.
5. Any sexual harassment on any social networking website during or outside of office hours
6. Any place visited by Employee or arising out of or during the course of employment with Organization, including transport services provided by Organization for undertaking such journey, audio/video conferencing applications, or any other communication-related tools/applications. For example, Employees who are on overseas programs and training in the course of their employment with the Organization.

e. Employer: A person responsible for management, supervision, and control of the workplace. Relanto has the right to take appropriate action against its employees under this policy if a complaint in respect of sexual harassment is filed by an outsider or third party who has visited the workplace.

f. Complainant: is any aggrieved individual (including a representative as more fully described under Rule 2 of the said Rules, if the aggrieved individual is unable to make a complaint on account of his/her physical or mental incapacity or death or otherwise) who makes a complaint alleging Sexual Harassment under this Policy.

g. Internal Committee: means and includes an Internal Complaints Committee (hereinafter referred to as the "IC").

h. Parties: means collectively the Complainant and the Respondent.

i. Sexual Harassment may occur not only when a person uses sexual behavior to control, influence, or affect the career, salary, or job of another person, but also between co-workers. It may also occur between an Employee and someone that the Employee deals with within the course of his/her work who is not employed by Relanto.

Sexual harassment includes any one or more of the following unwelcome and unwanted sexual conduct (whether written, verbal, non-verbal, gestural, or physical) directed at a person that is offensive or humiliating or behavior This encompasses a broad range of conduct including:

1. Unwelcome Physical contact and advances.
2. A demand or request for sexual favors.
3. Making sexually colored remarks.
4. Showing pornography or sexually offensive printed material.
5. Any other unwelcome physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature;
6. Creating a hostile work environment for women by putting a complainant (on sexual harassment) in a disadvantageous position concerning employment, associated privileges, benefits & career enhancement.

7. Stalking, intimidating, coercing, or threatening another person to get them to engage in sexual acts.
8. Commenting on someone's looks, dress, sexuality, or gender in a derogatory or objectifying manner or a manner that makes them uncomfortable.

The following circumstances, among other circumstances, if it occurs or is present about or connected with any act or behavior of sexual harassment may amount to sexual harassment:

1. Implied or explicit promise of preferential treatment in their employment; or
2. Implied or explicit threat of detrimental treatment in their employment; or
3. Implied or explicit threat about their present or future employment status; or
4. Interferes with their work or creates an intimidating offensive or hostile work environment for them; or
5. Humiliating treatment likely to affect their health or safety.

Further behaviors of sexual harassment are defined as, but not limited to:

1. Verbal harassment of a sexual nature, such as lewd comments, sexual jokes or references, and offensive personal references; demeaning, insulting, intimidating, or sexually suggestive comments (oral or written) about an individual's appearance or electronically transmitted messages (Jokes, remarks, letters, phone calls);
2. Demand or request for sexual favors, sexually colored remarks, showing pornography, any other unwelcome physical conduct of a sexual nature, lurid stares, physical contact or molestation, stalking, sounds, display of pictures, signs.
3. An act or conduct by a person in authority that makes the environment at the workplace hostile or intimidating to a person or unreasonably interferes with the individual's privacy and productivity at work.
4. Any other behavior that an individual perceives as having sexual overtones.

3.2 Redressal Mechanism

- If the Complainant is working for Relanto and in the course of the work, the Complainant has been sexually harassed by anyone through the means which are mentioned above, Relanto urges the Complainant to come forward with a written complaint as early as possible. The Complainant's complaint will be taken seriously, and confidentiality will be maintained by Relanto in the matter. Relanto has zero tolerance towards such practices once they are proven. A complaint concerning sexual harassment may be made by a written or electronic application addressed to the Internal Complaints Committee, through the President / or to any member of the Internal Complaints Committee.
- The complaint must be given to the persons specified above within 3 months of the occurrence (the complaint can be made within 6 months if the person can prove that there were some exceptional circumstances due to which the complaint could not be made earlier) and we advise the Complainant to be vigilant and keep any document which can be used to substantiate an allegation. The redressal system will work based on other evidence if the Complainant cannot produce any documentary evidence.
- If the Complainant cannot make a written complaint because of physical or mental incapacity or death, their legal heirs can make the complaint on their behalf.

3.3 Internal Committee

An Internal Committee (IC) has been constituted to prevent sexual harassment and to receive and effectively deal with complaints about the same. Details of the members, including their names and email ID, are given below.

The committee and its members have a tenure of 3 years.

Composition of Internal Committee:

Sr. No.	Name	Designation	Location
1.	Rashmi Hegde	Presiding Officer	Bengaluru
2.	Praveen Rajan	IC Member	Bengaluru
3.	Veena K G	IC Member	Bengaluru
4.	Manisha Nair	IC Member	Bengaluru
5.	Nagaraju B	IC Member	Hyderabad
6.	Kanaka Rekha Peddolla	IC Member	Hyderabad
7.	Sushant Wable	IC Member	Pune
8.	Vasanth Kotagiri	External Member	Bengaluru

3.4 Procedures and Guidelines:

Process for Conciliation:

Prior to initiating an inquiry, the IC may, at the written request of the Complainant take steps to settle the matter between the Complainant and the Respondent through conciliation. The following need to be kept in mind with respect to conciliation:

1. It is not mandatory for Complainant to request for Conciliation.
2. Conciliation cannot be done if inquiry has already started.
3. In case a settlement has been arrived at, the IC shall record it and forward it to Organization to take action as specified in the recommendation of the IC.
4. The IC will also provide copies of the settlement as recorded to the Complainant and the Respondent.
5. If conciliation has been reached, the IC will not be required to conduct any further inquiry.
6. Monetary settlement cannot be made the basis of such conciliation.
7. If the Complainant feels that the terms of Settlement are not being complied with by the Respondent or action has not been taken by the Organization, the Complainant can make a written complaint to the IC to conduct an inquiry into the complaint.

Procedure for Inquiry:

If the Complainant does not wish to go for conciliation or if the conciliation reached between the parties is not complied with, the IC shall, upon a written request from the Complainant to do so, proceed to make inquiry into the complaint in the manner as provided under this Policy and the Law. The following need to be kept in mind with respect to inquiry:

1. On receipt of the complaint, the IC shall send a copy of the complaint received from the Complainant to the Respondent within a period of 7 (seven) working days. If the complaint has been received on email, the IC member shall forward the same to the Respondent, with clear instructions that the same is not to be shared with anyone and strict confidentiality has to be maintained.
2. The Respondent shall file the reply to the complaint along with the list of documents, and names and addresses of witnesses (if any), within a period of 10 (ten) working days from the date of receipt of the documents.
3. If the Complainant or the Respondent desires any witness/es to be called, they shall communicate in writing to IC the names of witness/es whom they propose to call.
4. If the Complainant desires to tender any documents by way of evidence before IC, they shall supply copies of such documents. Similarly, if Respondent desires to tender any documents in evidence before IC they shall supply copies of such documents. Both shall affix their signature on the respective documents to certify these to be authentic documents.
5. The IC shall have the powers to summon and enforce the attendance of any person and conduct an examination, request the discovery and production of documents and / or any other matter which may be necessary for the inquiry process. Any refusal by any Employee of Organization to attend any hearing before the IC when summoned or to provide to the IC, any documents and / or information within their power or possession shall constitute as misconduct, rendering such Employee for adverse action by Organization.
6. The IC shall have the right to terminate the inquiry proceedings or to give an ex-parte decision on the complaint, if the Complainant or Respondent fails, without sufficient cause, to present themselves, for 3 (three) consecutive hearings convened by the Presiding Officer. Such termination or ex-parte order may not be passed without giving a notice in writing, 15 (fifteen) days in advance, to the Complainant or Respondent as the case maybe.
7. Conducting the inquiry, at any point of time, the Complaint shall be heard by a minimum of 3 (three) members including the Presiding Officer and the External Member and IC shall complete the inquiry within reasonable period but not beyond 90 (ninety) days.
8. IC shall notify in writing, the time and dates of its meetings to the Complainant, the Respondent and witnesses.
9. All inquiry proceedings will be documented in detail and treated as strictly confidential with restricted viewing only on need to know basis.
10. Inquiry proceedings shall be minuted/recorded in writing. They may be audio recorded as well (where possible). The minutes / transcribed record of the proceedings and the statement of witnesses shall be endorsed by the persons concerned and IC in token of authenticity thereof.
11. All colleagues and witnesses who are part of the IC proceedings will need to sign a confidentiality declaration.
12. Complainant and Respondent shall not be allowed to bring in any legal practitioner to represent them in their case at any stage of the proceedings before the IC.

The complainant can approach any member of the committee with his/her written complaint.

1. The investigation shall be completed within 3 months of the receipt of the complaint. If the investigation reveals that the Complainant has been sexually harassed as alleged, the accused will be subjected to disciplinary action accordingly.
2. The report of the investigation shall be supplied to the Employer (or the District Officer), the accused, and the Complainant within 10 days of completion of the investigation.
3. The Employer or the District Officer will act on the recommendations of the Committee within 60 days of the receipt of the report.
4. The contents of the complaint made, the identity and addresses of the Complainant, Respondent, and witnesses, any information relating to conciliation and inquiry proceedings, recommendations of the Internal Committee, and the action taken by the Employer shall not be published, communicated or made known to the public, press, and media in any manner.
5. Any party aggrieved by the report can prefer an appeal in the appropriate Court or Tribunal by the service rules within 90 days of the recommendation being given to the Employer/ District Officer.

Interim Relief:

1. The Complainant has the option to seek transfer or leave so that the inquiry process can continue smoothly and to prevent the recurrence of similar situations or discomfort to the Complainant. The leave can be extended for a maximum period of 3 months. Leave granted under this provision will be paid leave and will not be counted in the number of leaves that the Complainant is statutorily entitled to.
2. The Complainant may be required to work from home, if it is practicable, keeping in mind the nature of work of the complainant, health, and mental condition. However, the Complainant is under a good faith obligation and shall not abuse the process to request unjustifiably long periods of leave, keeping in mind the economic effects of the leave to Relanto. The Committee shall have the discretion to grant leave of an appropriate duration, depending on the facts and circumstances of the case, or grant an alternate measure such as transferring the employee or the accused, as it deems fit. The complainant and the accused shall be informed of the outcome of the investigation.

Considerations while preparing inquiry report:

While preparing the findings/recommendations, the following are considered:

1. Whether the language used (written or spoken), visual material or physical behavior was of sexual or derogatory nature;
2. Whether the allegations or events follow logically and reasonably from the evidence.
3. Credibility of Complainant, Respondent, witnesses and evidence;
4. Other similar facts, or evidence, e.g., if there have been any previous accounts of harassment about the Respondent.
5. Whether Parties have been allowed to be heard.
6. Whether a copy of the proceedings was made available to Parties enabling them to make representation against the findings.

7. Whether a copy of the final findings is shared with the Parties to allow them to make a representation of the findings to the Committee

3.5 Disciplinary Action:

Post the inquiry the committee submits its report containing the findings and recommendations to the Employer.

- Where any misconduct is found by the Committee, appropriate disciplinary action shall be taken against the Accused, up to and including termination. This action shall be in addition to any legal recourse sought by the Complainant.
- If it is found through evidence by the Committee that the Complainant has maliciously given a false complaint against the Accused, disciplinary action shall be taken against the Complainant as well.
- In conclusion, Relanto reiterates its commitment to providing its employees with a workplace free from harassment or discrimination of any kind and where every employee is treated with dignity and respect. This policy shall be disseminated to each Employee of Relanto as well as recruits who will have to acknowledge that they have read and understood the policy and that they shall abide by the policy.
- Where Respondent is an Employee, IC may recommend any one or more of the following:
- Where the Committee arrives at the conclusion that the allegation against the Respondent has been proved, where Respondent is an Employee it will recommend to the Company:

1. To take action for sexual harassment as a misconduct as per Organization Policy.

2. To take action any action including:

- A written apology from the Respondent
- A letter of warning may be given to the Respondent that will be placed in the personnel file
- Reprimand or censure the Respondent
- Withholding the promotion or reduction in rank
- Withholding of pay rise or increments
- Immediate transfer or suspension without pay
- Termination from service/dismissal from the services of the Organization
- Undergoing a counseling session
- Carrying out community service
- deduction from the salary or wages of the respondent such sum as it may consider appropriate to be paid to the Complainant or to their legal heirs. In case, the Organization is unable to make deductions from the salary of the Respondent due to them being absent from duty or cessation of employment, it may direct the Respondent to pay such sum to the Complainant. In case the Respondent fails to pay the sum, the IC may forward the order for recovery of the sum as an arrear of land revenue to the concerned district officer.

IC may consider various factors as required under Law for the purpose of determining the sums to be paid to the Complainant and may take the following into consideration:

- the mental trauma, pain, suffering and emotional distress caused to the Complainant
- the loss of the career opportunity due to the incident of sexual harassment
- medical expenses incurred by the victim for physical or psychiatric treatment
- the income and financial status of the Respondent

- feasibility of such payment in a lump sum or in instalments

Termination of Inquiry:

The Committee may terminate the inquiry or give an ex-parte decision, if Complainant or Respondent respectively is absent for 3 consecutive hearings, without reason. 15-day written notice to be given to the party, before termination or ex-parte order.

Complaint Unsubstantiated:

Where the Committee concludes that the allegation against the Respondent has not been proved, it recommends to the Employer that no action is required to be taken in this matter. Further, the Committee ensures that both parties understand that the matter has been fully investigated, that the matter is now concluded, and neither will be disadvantaged within Relanto.

Complaint Substantiated:

Where the Committee concludes that the allegation against the Respondent has been proved, it recommends to the Employer to take necessary action for sexual harassment as misconduct, according to the applicable service rules and policies, and this may include:

1. Counselling
2. Censure or reprimand
3. Apology to be tendered by respondent
4. Written warning
5. Withholding promotion and/or increments
6. Suspension
7. Termination
8. Or any other action that the Management may deem fit

Protection to Complainant:

Relanto is committed to ensuring that no Employee who brings forward a harassment concern is subject to any form of reprisal. Any reprisal will be subject to disciplinary action. Relanto will ensure that the victim or witnesses are not victimized or discriminated against while dealing with complaints of sexual harassment. However, anyone who abuses the procedure (for example, by maliciously making an allegation knowing it to be untrue and/or producing any forged or misleading document) will be subject to applicable disciplinary action.

Malicious Allegations:

Where the Committee concludes that the allegation against the Respondent is malicious or the aggrieved person or any other person making the complaint has made the complaint knowing it to be false or the aggrieved person or any other person making the complaint has produced any forged or misleading document, it may recommend to the Employer to take action against the person or the person making the complaint. The action recommended should be similar to the ones proposed for the Respondent in case of substantiated complaints. While deciding malicious intent, the committee should consider that mere inability to substantiate a complaint need not mean malicious intent. Malicious intent must be established through a separate inquiry.

Retaliation:

1. Relanto will not accept, support, or tolerate retaliation in any form against any employee who, acting in good faith, reports suspected misconduct, asks questions, or raises concerns.
2. Any person who engages in such retaliation directly or indirectly, or encourages others to do so, may be subject to appropriate disciplinary action. Retaliation will be treated as a major misconduct. Retaliation against those reporting sexual harassment is prohibited by this policy. Retaliation means and includes any hurtful employment action against an individual(s).
3. Anyone suspecting or experiencing retaliation should report to the appropriate authorities as prescribed in this policy.
4. Retaliation cases are treated as seriously as an alleged case of sexual harassment even if the original harassment complaint is not proven.

Filing of Complaint with Police:

Nothing in these rules and procedures shall preclude anybody from simultaneously lodging a complaint with the police in respect of any act amounting to an offense under the law. The organization will provide assistance in this regard if assistance is sought. This Policy is not intended to impair or limit the right of any employee seeking a remedy available under any law. Proceedings under this Policy shall continue notwithstanding any proceedings initiated by a Complainant (as defined hereinafter) against Respondent under any law in force.

In case of a complaint of sexual harassment or any other offense against a child, as per the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012 ("POCSO"), or in case of offense by a child, the provisions under POCSO and Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015 may become applicable and would have to be dealt with in accordance with these laws. A child is any person below the age of eighteen years.

3.6 Confidentiality:

This policy and the law prohibit any person including IC Members from publishing, communicating, or making known to the public, press, and media in any manner, the contents of the complaint, the identity, and addresses of the aggrieved person, respondent, and witnesses, any information relating to conciliation and inquiry proceedings, or recommendations of the IC during the proceedings under the provisions of the Act. Any violation thereto shall also be subject to applicable disciplinary action as stated above.

Given the dynamic nature of CSR activities, the Board retains the authority to amend or revise this Policy as necessary. The CSR programs encompass activities outlined in Schedule VII of the Companies Act, 2013.

The Human Resources department, in collaboration with other internal stakeholders, will manage the administration and execution of the policy. The formation of a CSR committee may be considered by the Company as deemed applicable in the future.

4. References

Not Applicable

5. Exclusion

Not Applicable

6. Non-Compliance

Non-compliance will attract consequences as prescribed under the Companies Act, 2013.

7. Revision of the Policy

The Company reserves the right to revise, modify any or all clauses of this Policy, at its discretion and in consonance with the extant laws

8. Explanation/Deviation of Policy

Board will be the sole authority to interpret the content of this Policy. Any deviation to this Policy needs to be approved by the Board. In the event of any inconsistency between this Policy and the applicable laws, the applicable laws will prevail.

9. Annexure

Not Applicable